In India too, Bhagat Singh has been remembered during the largest labour protest in human history, when no less than 1,25,000 farmers protested in retaliation to the passing of three ordinances on agricultural marketing. These were passed by the Modi government on 5 June 2020. Aimed at 'modernizing' Indian agriculture by opening it up to market forces, they brought about the biggest popular revolt against the government. What has been most interesting, however, is that along the several kilometres between the Tikri border in Delhi and Haryana's Bahadurgarh, where Punjab and Haryana's farmers have found a new cultural unity, it has been the name of Bhagat Singh that has been ringing out in musical performances, songs and dances—a sobering reminder perhaps of the words of the poet Faiz Ahmed Faiz: '*Vo intizar tha jis ka ye vo sahar to nahin*' ('This is not the dawn we were waiting for'). What that dawn could have been is what this book is about. And it lies in the now-forgotten story of Bhagat Singh.

Satvinder S. Juss
Vaisakhi, 2022